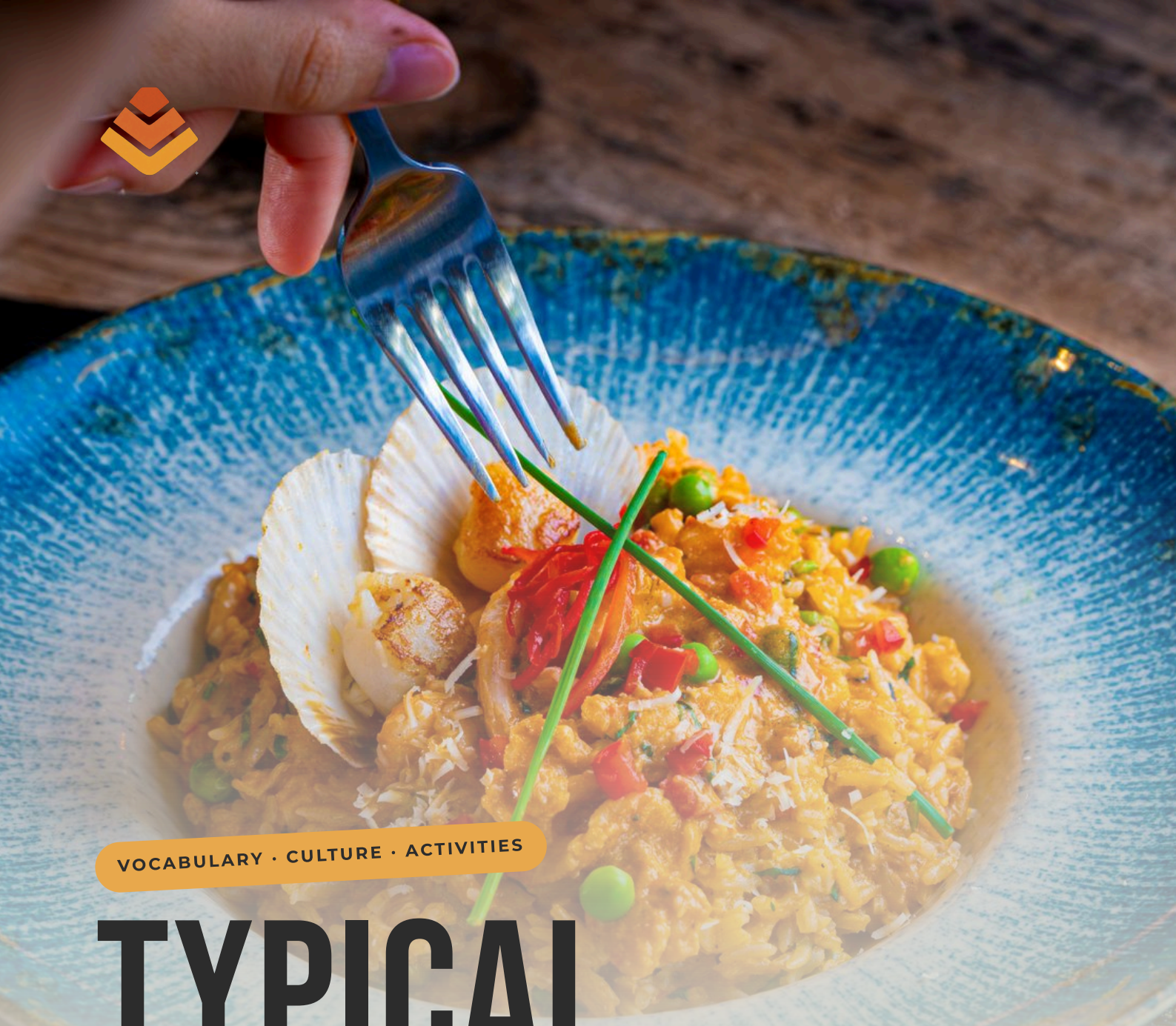


VOCABULARY · CULTURE · ACTIVITIES

TYPICAL DISHES

Las comidas típicas

A plate from every corner of the Spanish-speaking world, with Spain 🇪🇸 and Argentina 🇦🇷 vocabulary

PONCHO
SPANISH

¡BUEN PROVECHO!

You can learn a whole continent through its lunches. Twenty-one countries speak Spanish, and not one of them eats the same thing on a Sunday.

This resource takes you round the Spanish-speaking world one dish at a time: Spain, Mexico, Argentina and Uruguay, Peru and the Andes, the Caribbean and Central America, and a last section of puddings and drinks. More than 80 words and expressions, each one in a real sentence.

You don't need to have tried any of it. Read a little at a time, say the names out loud, and see how many of them you already recognise from a menu. At the end there are activities to check what you remember, and all the answers.

How to use it

1. **Read the word, then the sentence.** Words stick better when you see them in action.
2. **Say the dish out loud.** Choripán, pupusa, chimichurri: they're fun to say.
3. **Find the country on a map.** Every dish here has a home.
4. **Try the activities** without looking back, then check the answers.

La tortilla no es la tortilla

The same word, two completely different dishes. In Spain **la tortilla** is a thick omelette with potato; in Mexico it is a thin flatbread made of maize that you wrap round your lunch.

la tortilla 🇪🇸 = **a potato omelette**

Un plato, muchos nombres

Food is where Spanish changes the most from country to country. When you see two options, the first is common in Spain 🇪🇸 and the second in Argentina 🇦🇷.

la patata 🇪🇸 = **la papa** 🇦🇷

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01

ESPAÑA

FROM THE SPANISH KITCHEN

Olive oil, a very long lunch and a frying pan that never rests.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la tortilla de patatas	the Spanish omelette	*La tortilla de patatas lleva huevo, patata y cebolla.* Spanish omelette has egg, potato and onion in it.
la paella	the paella	*La paella se cocina en una sartén muy grande.* Paella is cooked in a very big pan.
el arroz	the rice	*El arroz tiene que quedar suelto.* The rice has to stay loose.
el jamón	the cured ham	*El jamón se corta muy fino.* Cured ham is sliced very thinly.
el gazpacho	the cold tomato soup	*En verano tomamos gazpacho bien frío.* In summer we drink gazpacho ice-cold.
las tapas	the tapas	*Salimos a tomar unas tapas.* We're going out for some tapas.
la croqueta	the croquette	*Las croquetas de mi abuela son las mejores.* My grandmother's croquettes are the best.
el pulpo	the octopus	*En Galicia comen pulpo con pimentón.* In Galicia they eat octopus with paprika.
el cocido	the chickpea stew	*El cocido se come en invierno.* Cocido is eaten in winter.
el aceite de oliva	the olive oil	*Aquí se cocina todo con aceite de oliva.* Here everything is cooked with olive oil.

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01 · ESPAÑA

FROM THE SPANISH KITCHEN

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el pan con tomate	bread rubbed with tomato	*En Cataluña siempre hay pan con tomate.* In Catalonia there is always pan con tomate.
la patata 🇪🇸 la papa 🇦🇷	the potato	*¿Me pasas las patatas?* Can you pass me the potatoes?
el bocadillo 🇪🇸 el sánguche 🇦🇷	the sandwich	*Me llevo un bocadillo al colegio.* I take a sandwich to school.
los churros	the churros	*Los churros se mojan en el chocolate.* You dip churros in the hot chocolate.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Paella comes from Valencia, on the east coast, and the original version has no seafood at all: chicken, rabbit, green beans and a flat white bean called garrofó. The word paella is actually the name of the pan, not of the dish.

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02

MÉXICO

MAIZE, CHILLI AND CHOCOLATE

Three things Mexico gave the world: maize, chilli and chocolate.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el taco	the taco	*Un taco es una tortilla con algo dentro.* A taco is a tortilla with something inside.
la tortilla de maíz	the corn tortilla	*Aquí la tortilla es de maíz, no de patata.* Here the tortilla is made of maize, not potato.
el maíz	the maize, the corn	*El maíz está en casi todos los platos.* Maize is in almost every dish.
el guacamole	the guacamole	*El guacamole lleva aguacate, lima y cilantro.* Guacamole has avocado, lime and coriander in it.
el aguacate 🇪🇸 la palta 🇦🇷	the avocado	*Un aguacate maduro se abre solo.* A ripe avocado opens by itself.
el tamal	the tamal	*Los tamales se cocinan envueltos en hoja.* Tamales are cooked wrapped in a leaf.
el mole	the mole sauce	*El mole lleva chile y chocolate.* Mole has chilli and chocolate in it.
la quesadilla	the quesadilla	*La quesadilla se derrite por dentro.* A quesadilla melts on the inside.
el pozole	the pozole stew	*El pozole se come los días de fiesta.* Pozole is eaten on special days.
el chile	the chilli	*Hay más de sesenta tipos de chile.* There are more than sixty kinds of chilli.

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02 · MÉXICO

MAIZE, CHILLI AND CHOCOLATE

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
picante	spicy, hot	*¿Pica mucho? Un poquito.* Is it very spicy? Just a little.
la salsa	the sauce, the salsa	*Cada mesa tiene tres salsas.* Every table has three salsas.
los frijoles	the beans	*Los frijoles acompañan casi todo.* Beans go with almost everything.
el elote	the corn on the cob	*El elote se vende en la calle.* Corn on the cob is sold in the street.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Chocolate is a Mexican word. The Aztecs drank cacao bitter, with chilli and no sugar at all, and called it xocolātl. The sweet bar you know today only appeared in Europe centuries later, once somebody added milk and sugar.

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03

ARGENTINA Y URUGUAY

FIRE, PASTRY AND CARAMEL

A grill on a Sunday, a thermos under one arm and dulce de leche in everything.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el asado	the barbecue	*El asado del domingo dura toda la tarde.* Sunday's asado goes on all afternoon.
la parrilla	the grill	*La carne se hace despacio en la parrilla.* The meat cooks slowly on the grill.
la carne	the meat	*Acá la carne es muy buena.* The meat here is very good.
el choripán	the sausage sandwich	*El choripán se come de pie.* You eat a choripán standing up.
la empanada	the empanada, the pasty	*Cada provincia hace la empanada distinta.* Every province makes empanadas differently.
el chimichurri	the chimichurri sauce	*El chimichurri lleva perejil, ajo y vinagre.* Chimichurri has parsley, garlic and vinegar in it.
la milanesa	the breaded escalope	*La milanesa con puré es un clásico.* Milanesa with mash is a classic.
el dulce de leche	the caramel milk spread	*El dulce de leche va en todo.* Dulce de leche goes in everything.
el alfajor	the alfajor biscuit	*Un alfajor son dos galletas y dulce de leche.* An alfajor is two biscuits and dulce de leche.
el mate	the mate	*El mate se comparte entre todos.* Mate is shared round the whole group.

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03 · ARGENTINA Y URUGUAY

FIRE, PASTRY AND CARAMEL

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la yerba	the yerba mate leaves	*Sin yerba no hay mate.* Without yerba there is no mate.
el locro	the locro stew	*El locro se come el 25 de mayo.* Locro is eaten on 25 May.
la provoleta	the grilled provolone	*La provoleta sale burbujeando.* The provoleta comes out bubbling.
el helado	the ice cream	*El helado de dulce de leche gana siempre.* Dulce de leche ice cream wins every time.

¿Sabías que...?

Mate is drunk from a shared cup through a metal straw called la bombilla, and it has rules: one person pours for everybody, you drink the whole cup before passing it back, and saying «gracias» means you've had enough. Saying it too early is the classic beginner's mistake.

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04

PERÚ Y LOS ANDES

FISH, LIME AND THREE THOUSAND POTATOES

Peru, Chile and Bolivia: the Pacific on one side, the mountains on the other, and the potato's original home in the middle.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el ceviche	the ceviche	*El ceviche se hace con pescado crudo y limón.* Ceviche is made with raw fish and lime.
el pescado	the fish	*El pescado tiene que ser fresquísimo.* The fish has to be extremely fresh.
el limón	the lime, the lemon	*El limón cocina el pescado sin fuego.* The lime cooks the fish without any heat.
crudo / cruda	raw	*Parece crudo, pero no lo está.* It looks raw, but it isn't.
el lomo saltado	the stir-fried beef	*El lomo saltado mezcla Perú y China.* Lomo saltado mixes Peru and China.
la papa	the potato	*En Perú hay más de tres mil papas.* In Peru there are more than three thousand potatoes.
la causa	the layered potato dish	*La causa se sirve fría.* Causa is served cold.
el ají	the chilli pepper	*El ají amarillo pinta el plato de color.* Yellow ají paints the dish with colour.
el anticucho	the beef-heart skewer	*Los anticuchos se asan en la calle.* Anticuchos are grilled in the street.
la quinua	the quinoa	*La quinua crece en la montaña.* Quinoa grows up in the mountains.

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04 · PERÚ Y LOS ANDES

FISH, LIME AND THREE THOUSAND POTATOES

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el choclo	the corn on the cob	*El choclo de los Andes tiene granos enormes.* Andean corn has enormous kernels.
el pastel de choclo	the sweetcorn pie	*El pastel de choclo es chileno.* Pastel de choclo is Chilean.
la cazuela	the broth with vegetables	*La cazuela se toma bien caliente.* Cazuela is drunk piping hot.
la chicha morada	the purple maize drink	*La chicha morada es dulce y oscura.* Chicha morada is sweet and dark.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Every potato in the world comes from the Andes. People there have been growing them for about eight thousand years, and there are still more than three thousand varieties: purple ones, yellow ones, tiny ones and ones that only grow above four thousand metres.

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05

EL CARIBE Y CENTROAMÉRICA

MAIZE FLOUR, PLANTAIN AND BEANS

Rice and beans in every house, and a plantain on the side of the plate.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la arepa	the corn flatbread	*La arepa se abre y se rellena.* You open an arepa and fill it.
la harina de maíz	the maize flour	*La arepa se hace con harina de maíz.* An arepa is made with maize flour.
la hallaca	the hallaca	*En Venezuela la hallaca es de Navidad.* In Venezuela the hallaca is a Christmas dish.
el gallo pinto	rice with beans	*El gallo pinto se desayuna.* Gallo pinto is eaten for breakfast.
la pupusa	the stuffed flatbread	*La pupusa es de El Salvador.* The pupusa is from El Salvador.
el mofongo	the mashed plantain dish	*El mofongo se machaca en un mortero.* Mofongo is mashed in a pestle and mortar.
el plátano	the plantain, the banana	*El plátano frito acompaña el arroz.* Fried plantain goes with the rice.
los tostones	the fried plantain slices	*Los tostones se aplastan y se fríen dos veces.* Tostones are flattened and fried twice.
la yuca	the cassava	*La yuca se hierve y se fríe.* Cassava is boiled and then fried.
los frijoles negros	the black beans	*Los frijoles negros van con arroz blanco.* Black beans go with white rice.

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05 · EL CARIBE Y CENTROAMÉRICA MAIZE FLOUR, PLANTAIN AND BEANS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la ropa vieja	the shredded beef stew	*La ropa vieja es un plato cubano.* Ropa vieja is a Cuban dish.
el ajiaco	the chicken and potato soup	*El ajiaco es de Bogotá.* Ajiaco is from Bogotá.
la bandeja paisa	the Colombian mixed platter	*La bandeja paisa no te la acabas.* You can never finish a bandeja paisa.
el coco	the coconut	*El arroz con coco se come en la costa.* Coconut rice is eaten on the coast.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In Costa Rica and Nicaragua breakfast is gallo pinto, 'spotted rooster': rice and beans fried together until the white rice turns speckled. Both countries insist they invented it, and neither has ever agreed to settle the argument.

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06

DULCES Y BEBIDAS

PUDDINGS AND DRINKS

What comes after the plate, and what stays on the table long afterwards.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el postre	the pudding, the dessert	*¿Qué hay de postre?* What's for pudding?
el flan	the crème caramel	*El flan tiembla cuando lo sacas.* A flan wobbles when you take it out.
el arroz con leche	the rice pudding	*El arroz con leche lleva canela.* Rice pudding has cinnamon on it.
el pastel de tres leches	the three-milk cake	*El pastel de tres leches está empapado.* Tres leches cake is completely soaked.
el turrón	the nougat	*El turrón aparece en diciembre.* Nougat shows up in December.
la tarta 🇪🇸 la torta 🇦🇷	the cake	*¿Quién quiere un trozo de tarta?* Who wants a slice of cake?
la horchata	the tiger-nut drink	*La horchata se toma muy fría.* Horchata is drunk very cold.
el café con leche	the white coffee	*Un café con leche y una tostada.* A white coffee and a piece of toast.
el zumo 🇪🇸 el jugo 🇦🇷	the juice	*Un zumo de naranja, por favor.* An orange juice, please.
el batido 🇪🇸 el licuado 🇦🇷	the milkshake, the smoothie	*Me hago un batido de plátano.* I make myself a banana milkshake.

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06 · DULCES Y BEBIDAS PUDDINGS AND DRINKS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el agua fresca	the fruit water	*El agua fresca de sandía es mexicana.* Watermelon agua fresca is Mexican.
el desayuno	the breakfast	*El desayuno aquí es pequeño.* Breakfast here is small.
la merienda	the afternoon snack	*La merienda es a las cinco.* The afternoon snack is at five.
la sobremesa	the chat after a meal	*La sobremesa dura más que la comida.* The sobremesa lasts longer than the meal.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

There is no English word for sobremesa: the time you stay at the table after the food has gone, talking. In Spain and most of Latin America it is the real point of lunch, and nobody stands up until it is over.

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07

FRASES EN LA MESA

PHRASES FOR ORDERING AND EATING

Short sentences you could really say in a restaurant or at somebody's table. When there are two versions, the second is how you'd say it in Argentina.

¿Qué vas a comer?
What are you going to have?

Yo quiero una empanada, por favor.
I'd like an empanada, please.

¿Qué lleva este plato?
What's in this dish?

Lleva carne, cebolla y huevo.
It has meat, onion and egg in it.

Soy vegetariano. / Soy vegetariana.
I'm vegetarian.

No como carne.
I don't eat meat.

¿Pica mucho?
Is it very spicy?

Pica un poquito.
It's a little bit spicy.

¡Está riquísimo!
It's delicious!

¿Me pasas la sal?
Can you pass me the salt?

La cuenta, por favor.
The bill, please.

¡Buen provecho!
Enjoy your meal!

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

«¡Buen provecho!» is said to anybody who is eating, even strangers at the next table, and in much of Latin America you say it as you leave a restaurant. There is no real English equivalent: 'enjoy your meal' is the closest, and it sounds far more formal.

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08

¡A PRACTICAR!

ACTIVITIES

1 MATCH THEM UP

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Spanish word or phrase.

1	el asado	☐	A	the pasty, the turnover
2	la empanada	☐	B	the caramel milk spread
3	el ceviche	☐	C	the Spanish omelette
4	la arepa	☐	D	the barbecue
5	el mole	☐	E	spicy
6	el dulce de leche	☐	F	the chilli and chocolate sauce
7	la tortilla de patatas	☐	G	rice with beans
8	el gallo pinto	☐	H	raw fish cured in lime
9	el flan	☐	I	the crème caramel
10	picante	☐	J	the corn flatbread

2 ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

Read each sentence and circle V (true) or F (false).

1. La paella es un plato típico de España. **V** **F**
2. El ceviche se cocina en el horno. **V** **F**
3. El mate se toma con una bombilla. **V** **F**
4. El guacamole lleva aguacate. **V** **F**
5. La arepa se hace con harina de maíz. **V** **F**
6. El dulce de leche es un plato salado. **V** **F**

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3 UNA POSTAL DESDE LIMA

Complete Daniela's postcard with the words from the box.

comida · plato · pescado · limón · papas · picante · postre · cocinar

¡Hola! Estoy en Perú y la _____ de aquí es increíble. Mi _____ favorito es el ceviche: lleva _____ crudo, mucho _____ y un poco de ají. Se come con maíz y con _____ amarillas. No es muy _____, pero te despierta. De _____ pedí arroz con leche. Cuando vuelva te lo voy a _____. ¡Un beso!

4 SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

Write the word used in Argentina next to the one used in Spain.

- **la patata** → _____
- **la tarta** → _____
- **el aguacate** → _____
- **el batido** → _____
- **el zumo** → _____
- **el camarero** → _____
- **el maíz** → _____
- **el bocadillo** → _____

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5 SOPA DE LETRAS

Find the 12 words. They go across → or down ↓.

T	U	L	L	M	V	R	U	P	C	C	I
P	F	L	A	N	R	C	B	J	U	P	J
A	A	N	E	M	P	A	N	A	D	A	M
E	S	A	P	M	A	F	T	V	D	R	B
L	A	G	J	E	R	H	A	M	O	L	E
L	D	N	N	R	E	C	C	F	P	N	T
A	O	I	E	O	P	T	O	I	O	M	N
H	E	C	F	E	A	M	A	T	E	H	H
A	R	U	C	H	O	C	L	O	F	I	J
C	E	V	I	C	H	E	A	E	O	T	M
V	Y	U	C	A	U	L	E	S	V	B	P
T	T	A	M	A	L	N	N	N	N	D	R

PAELLA
TACO
ASADO
CEVICHE
AREPA
MOLE
EMPANADA
FLAN
TAMAL
MATE
CHOCLO
YUCA

6 PUT IT IN ORDER

Unscramble each sentence and write it on the line.

1. lleva / ¿Qué / este / plato

_____

2. Yo / empanada / una / quiero

_____

3. por / favor / La / cuenta,

_____

4. entre / comparte / todos / El / mate / se

_____

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7 TU PLATO FAVORITO

Choose one dish from this resource and write four or five sentences about it: which country it comes from, what it has in it, when people eat it and whether you would like to try it. Use at least six words from this resource.

Try: Mi plato favorito es... Es de... Lleva... Se come... Me gustaría probarlo.

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ANSWERS

1 · MATCH THEM UP

1–D, 2–A, 3–H, 4–J, 5–F, 6–B, 7–C, 8–G, 9–I, 10–E

2 · ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

1 V, 2 F, 3 V, 4 V, 5 V, 6 F

3 · UNA POSTAL DESDE LIMA

1. comida, 2. plato, 3. pescado, 4. limón, 5. papas, 6. picante, 7. postre, 8. cocinar

4 · SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

la patata → la papa; el aguacate → la palta; el zumo → el jugo; el maíz → el choclo; la tarta → la torta; el batido → el licuado; el camarero → el mozo; el bocadillo → el sánguche

6 · PUT IT IN ORDER

¿Qué lleva este plato? · Yo quiero una empanada. · La cuenta, por favor. · El mate se comparte entre todos.

7 · TU PLATO FAVORITO

Any answer that uses six words from this resource is perfect. Better still: cook one of them this weekend and say the name out loud when you serve it.

5 · SOPA DE LETRAS

T	U	L	L	M	V	R	U	P	C	C	I
P	F	L	A	N	R	C	B	J	U	P	J
A	A	N	E	M	P	A	N	A	D	A	M
E	S	A	P	M	A	F	T	V	D	R	B
L	A	G	J	E	R	H	A	M	O	L	E
L	D	N	N	R	E	C	C	F	P	N	T
A	O	I	E	O	P	T	O	I	O	M	N
H	E	C	F	E	A	M	A	T	E	H	H
A	R	U	C	H	O	C	L	O	F	I	J
C	E	V	I	C	H	E	A	E	O	T	M
V	Y	U	C	A	U	L	E	S	V	B	P
T	T	A	M	A	L	N	N	N	N	D	R

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¡BUEN PROVECHO!

SEE YOU SOON

Twenty-one countries, one language and a very long lunch. You don't need a plane ticket to start: pick one dish from this resource, look up how it's made, and ask for it in Spanish.

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SPANISH

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